

Buyer & Receiver

The paired supply-chain roles that keep the shop fed — buying the right material and services at the right time, and verifying every box that arrives.

PROCUREMENT

“ Nothing gets made until the material shows up, the paperwork clears, and the dock says it's good to go.

WHO THEY ARE

The Buyer works ProShop's demand-based Purchasing dashboard, placing vendor POs for material, tooling, commercial hardware, and outside-processing services at the right time, cost, and lead time. The Receiver works the Receiving dashboard, verifying every box against its PO and packing slip, inspecting quality and documents, and routing material to the work cell or into inventory.

In small shops one person does both; in larger shops they're separate desks that lend each other staff on busy weeks and jointly own supplier performance. Notably, in ProShop purchasing and receiving live on the *same record* — unusual versus other ERPs.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Demand	Buyer opens the Purchasing dashboard — four tabs of queued demand: part stock, COTS, tooling, OSP.
Quote	For new items, negotiates ~3 quotes for competitive price and lead time before placing.
Order	Batches lines into carts by vendor; places POs by PDF+email or vendor portal; sets status to Outstanding.
Receive	Receiver starts on the Receiving dashboard — today's, late, and future POs; verifies against packing slip.
Inspect	Quality-checks each delivery, captures certs and lot numbers; quarantines anything with missing docs.
Release	Records receipt (partial OK); routes part stock to the work cell or COTS to the inventory table.

SNAPSHOT

Workflow stage	Procurement
Buyer PO types	4 (stock/COTS/tool/OSP)
Quotes per new item	~3
Shared record?	Purchasing = Receiving
Feeds	Supplier scorecards

ENVIRONMENT & TECH COMFORT

Buyer is desk-based in dashboards and vendor portals; Receiver is on their feet at the dock with a scanner, packing slips, and inspection tools. Between them they span pure knowledge work and physical, glove-on verification — two quite different UI contexts on one shared record.

Software proficiency	Medium–High
Manufacturing depth	Medium
Time pressure at the dock	High

IN THEIR WORDS

“ProShop is demand-based — I don't decide what to buy, the shop's work-order load does. My job is to make sure nothing needed gets missed.”

WHAT DRIVES THEM — AND WHAT GETS IN THE WAY

The lens Product & Design should hold when building for this user: what they're trying to achieve, where the current experience fails them, and what they need from the product to succeed.

● GOALS

- Get the right material and services in at the right time, cost, and paperwork.
- Consolidate demand into batched POs to cut vendor noise and shipping fees.
- Get ahead of demand using forecasts — don't wait for the WO to trigger.
- Hold the line on quality inspection under production pressure.

● FRUSTRATIONS

- No RFQ module for vendor POs yet — buyers still work in email and Excel.
- Stale inventory counts erode trust in the on-hand numbers.
- Planners sometimes queue POs with impossible past-due dates.
- Receivers get pressured to skip inspection when production is desperate.

● NEEDS FROM PROSHOP

- A vendor RFQ workspace inside ProShop, not email + spreadsheets.
- Trustworthy on-hand counts — a 'quantity verified' freshness signal.
- PO due dates surfaced on the work-order view, not hidden until drill-in.
- A fast, glove-friendly receiving flow that still enforces the cert capture.

THE NUMBERS THEY'RE MEASURED ON

Supplier OTD

Vendor on-time delivery — upstream of the shop's 95% to the client.

Scorecards

Quality, packaging, lead time, price, and service, per supplier.

3 quotes

Price competitiveness — three quotes for every new item.

RMA count

Discrepancies caught at the dock, not on the machine.

PROSHOP MODULES THEY LIVE IN

Inventory & Material Planning **HOME**

Tool & Fixture Management **HOME**

Sales & Work Orders **READS**

Quality Systems & Inspection **READS**

Job Costing & Financial Data **READS**

WHERE THEY SIT IN THE FLOW

UPSTREAM

Planner / PM

Queues purchasing demand from finalized WOs

DEMAND →

THIS PERSONA

Buyer & Receiver

Buys, receives, inspects & releases material

→ MATERIAL

DOWNSTREAM

Tool Crib & Operator

Get released material at the machine

Six demand streams pool into one Purchasing dashboard so nothing needed gets missed. If a planner's status-date field is empty the Buyer never sees the demand — and the Receiver is the last line of defense before material reaches the floor with bad paperwork.

Source: ProShop persona sessions + product docs. The no-RFQ-module gap was flagged in-session as on the roadmap.

Authored and updated 8/27/2026 by Samantha Jorgenson, Product Operations Manager

Buyer & Receiver · Page 2 / 2